

Word family: ****especially / especial / special / specially****

****Base target:** especially**

****Closely related forms:** especial, special, specially**

****Part of speech:** adverb (副詞)**

Your sentence:

> “I still use them now, ****especially**** when I am travelling or trying to focus.”

A semantic note first: ****especially** does not have many completely unrelated meanings**. It has one strong core idea:

> ****giving extra emphasis to one person, thing, situation, reason, or degree because it stands out from the others****

So we should ****not artificially split it into lots of separate meanings****. The main differences are contextual.

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****especially**** means:

****particularly / more than in other situations****

The speaker uses the headphones at other times too, but uses them ****more particularly or finds them especially useful**** when travelling or trying to concentrate.

****繁體中文： **特別是在.....的情況下；在多種情況之中，這些情況尤其值得強調****

Natural translation:

> “I still use them now, especially when I am travelling or trying to focus.”

「我現在仍然會使用它們，****尤其是在旅行或想集中精神的時候****。」

So here:

****especially when... = 尤其是在.....的時候 / 特別是在.....的情況下****

1. ****especially + person/thing/situation (人 / 事物 / 情況) — 尤其；特別是****

****Meaning:**** Used to single out one person, thing, or situation as more important, noticeable, relevant, or true than others.

This is your original meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I still use them now, ****especially**** when I am travelling or trying to focus.”

「我現在仍然會使用它們，****尤其是在旅行或想集中精神的時候****。」

Practice 2

> “I enjoy travelling, ****especially**** by train.”

「我喜歡旅行，****尤其喜歡乘火車旅行****。」

Practice 3

> “The café is busy, ****especially**** at lunchtime.”

「那間咖啡店很忙，****尤其是在午餐時間****。」

****especially = 在多個人、事物或情況中，特別把其中一個提出來加以強調****

2. ****especially + adjective/adverb (形容詞 / 副詞) — 特別；尤其；格外****

Here, ****especially**** intensifies a quality or degree.

Practice 4

> “The headphones are ****especially useful**** on long flights.”

「這副耳機在長途航班上****特別有用****。」

Practice 5

> “The office was ****especially noisy**** that afternoon.”

「那天下午辦公室****格外嘈雜****。」

****especially + adjective/adverb = 表示某種特質或程度比一般情況更加突出****

Common examples:

- * especially important = 尤其重要
- * especially difficult = 特別困難
- * especially useful = 特別有用
- * especially well = 特別好

3. **especially because / since + reason (原因) — 尤其因為；特別是因為**

This is a contextual branch of the same core meaning.

Practice 6

> “I chose these headphones, **especially because** they were comfortable.”

「我選擇這副耳機，**尤其是因為它們佩戴舒服**。」

Practice 7

> “The trip was tiring, **especially because** we had not slept well.”

「這趟旅程很累，**尤其是因為我們之前沒有睡好**。」

especially because... = 在多個原因之中，特別強調某一個原因

4. **especially if / when + condition (條件 / 情況) — 尤其如果；尤其當.....時**

This is exactly the structure in your sentence.

Practice 8

> “Noise-cancelling headphones are useful, **especially if** you travel often.”

「降噪耳機很有用，**尤其如果你經常旅行**。」

Practice 9

> “It can be hard to concentrate, **especially when** the office is crowded.”

「有時很難集中精神，**尤其當辦公室很擠迫的時候**。」

especially if/when = 在某些條件或情況中特別如此，因此把該情況突出強調

5. **especially + one member of a group — 尤其是其中某一個**

Practice 10

> “I like all kinds of music, **especially jazz**.”

「各種音樂我都喜歡，**尤其是爵士樂**。」

Practice 11

> “Everyone was helpful, **especially Anna**.”

「每個人都很幫忙，**尤其是 Anna**。」

especially + noun/person = 在整個群體之中，特別突出某一個人或事物

6. **not especially + adjective (程度不高) — 不特別；不太**

This is a very common conversational use.

Practice 12

> “The headphones are good, but they are **not especially cheap**.”

「這副耳機很好，但**並不特別便宜 / 不算很便宜**。」

Practice 13

> “I’m **not especially interested** in that brand.”

「我對那個品牌**並沒有特別大的興趣**。」

not especially = 程度沒有特別高；不算特別.....

It is often softer than saying:

> “I’m not interested.”

Compare:

> “I’m not especially interested.”

> = 我不是特別有興趣。

> “I’m not interested.”

> = 我沒有興趣。

7. ****especially so = in that case to an even greater degree — 在那種情況下尤其如此****

A useful expression.

Practice 14

> “Travelling can be tiring, ****especially so**** during the holiday season.”

「旅行有時會很累，****在假期期間尤其如此****。」

Practice 15

> “The headphones are useful in noisy places, ****especially so**** on crowded trains.”

「這副耳機在嘈雜地方很有用，****在擠迫的火車上尤其如此****。」

****especially so = 前面所說的情況在某個特定例子中更加明顯****

Important distinction: ****especially vs particularly****

These two overlap heavily.

****especially****

often singles something out from a group or set of situations.

> “I like fruit, especially mangoes.”

「我喜歡水果，尤其是芒果。」

****particularly****

can do the same, but often sounds slightly more formal or neutral.

> “I particularly enjoyed the final section.”

「我尤其喜歡最後一部分。」

In many sentences, they are interchangeable:

> “This feature is especially useful.”

> “This feature is particularly useful.”

Both:

「這項功能特別有用。」

Important distinction: **especially vs specially**

This is the most important contrast in this family.

especially

= particularly / more than others

尤其；特別

> “I use the headphones especially when travelling.”

「我尤其在旅行時使用這副耳機。」

specially

= for a particular purpose / in a special way

特地；專門；特別為某個目的

> “These headphones were specially designed for travellers.”

「這副耳機是**專門為旅客設計的**。」

So:

especially = 尤其、格外

specially = 特地、專門

Compare carefully

> “I bought this especially because it was comfortable.”

= 我買它**尤其是因為**它很舒服。

→ reason emphasized

> “I bought this specially for you.”

= 我**特地買這個給你**。

→ purpose

That distinction is excellent for MCQ questions.

8. **specially + purpose/person (目的 / 對象) — 特地 ; 專門**

Since this is the closest family contrast, it deserves its own section.

Practice 16

> “The room was **specially designed** for recording.”

「這個房間是**專門為錄音而設計的**。」

Practice 17

> “I made this **specially for you**.”

「這是我**特地為你做的**。」

specially = 為某個特定目的、對象或情況而特別安排 / 製作

9. **special = different from ordinary because important/distinctive — 特別的 ; 特殊的**

This is the adjective family member.

Practice 18

> “These headphones have a **special** feature for reducing wind noise.”

「這副耳機有一項減少風噪的**特殊功能**。」

Practice 19

> “It was a **special** day for the family.”

「那天對這個家庭來說是個**特別而有意義的日子**。」

special = 因具有不同尋常的特徵、重要性或意義，而與普通情況有別的

10. **special = intended for a particular purpose/person — 專用的；特別安排的**

Practice 20

> “The hotel offers a **special** service for business travellers.”

「酒店為商務旅客提供**特別安排的專門服務**。」

Practice 21

> “You need a **special** tool to open this case.”

「你需要一件**專用工具**才能打開這個外殼。」

special = 為特定用途、對象或情況而設計 / 安排的

This is closely related to the idea behind **specially**.

11. **especial = particular / exceptional (較正式 / 較少見) — 特別的；尤其重要的**

Especial is a real word, but it is much less common than **special**.

It survives mainly in certain formal expressions.

Practice 22

> “This issue is of **especial importance**.”

「這個問題**尤其重要**。」

Practice 23

> “She showed an **especial interest** in modern art.”

「她對現代藝術表現出**特別濃厚的興趣**。」

especial = 特別值得注意、重視或強調的

For normal everyday English, **special** is usually much more natural.

Important distinction: special vs especial

special

very common and broad.

> “a special occasion”

「特殊 / 特別の場合」

especial

much less common and usually more formal.

> “of especial importance”

「尤其重要」

You normally would **not** replace every **special** with **especial**.

For example:

> “a special offer” 

not normally:

> “an especial offer” 

Important distinction: especially vs in particular

especially

fits smoothly inside a sentence:

> “I use them especially when travelling.”

in particular

often highlights one item more explicitly:

> “I use them when travelling, in particular on long flights.”

「我旅行時會使用它們，尤其是在長途航班上。」

Both express selection from a broader group.

Important distinction: **especially vs mainly**

especially

= one case stands out more than others, but other cases still apply.

mainly

= the majority or principal reason/use is this one.

Compare:

> “I use them **especially** when travelling.”

= 我在很多情況都會用，但**旅行時尤其會用**。

> “I use them **mainly** when travelling.”

= 我**主要是在旅行時使用**，其他時候較少。

This is a subtle but important difference.

Important distinction: **especially vs only**

These are very different.

> “I use them **especially** when travelling.”

= 我旅行時尤其常用，但其他時候也可能用。

> “I use them **only** when travelling.”

= 我**只在旅行時**使用，其他時候不用。

So **especially** does not exclude other situations**.**

Word-position note

****Especially**** often comes directly before the element being emphasized.

Before a noun:

> “I like fruit, ****especially mangoes****.”

Before an adjective:

> “It is ****especially useful****.”

Before a clause:

> “It helps, ****especially when I’m travelling****.”

Before a reason:

> “I bought it ****especially because**** it was comfortable.”

This helps you identify exactly ****what is being emphasized****.

Family-extension sweep

After a full family sweep, the useful core is:

- * ****especially**** = 尤其；特別；格外
- * ****not especially**** = 不特別；不太
- * ****especially when/if**** = 尤其當……時 / 尤其如果……
- * ****especially because**** = 尤其是因為……
- * ****especially so**** = 在那種情況下尤其如此
- * ****special**** = 特別的；特殊的；專用的
- * ****specially**** = 特地；專門
- * ****especial**** = 尤其值得注意的；較正式、較少見

The family is ****not very large****, so I would stop here rather than inflate it with obscure forms.

Master comparison

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especially — selection	在多個人、事物或情況之中，特別把其中一個提出來加以強調	
especially + adjective/adverb	表示某種特質或程度比一般情況更加突出	
especially when/if	在某個特定條件或情況下，前面所述情況尤其明顯	
especially because	在多個可能原因中，特別強調其中一個原因	
not especially	程度不算特別高；不太.....	
especially so	前面所說的情況在某個特定例子中更加明顯	
specially	為某個特定目的、對象或情況而特地安排 / 製作	
special — distinctive	因具有不同尋常的特徵、重要性或意義而與普通情況有別的	
special — purpose	為特定用途或對象而設計 / 安排的	
especial	特別值得注意或重視的；較正式、較少見	

For your original sentence

> “I still use them now, ****especially when I am travelling or trying to focus****.”

The exact meaning is:

****especially = 在所有會使用這副耳機的情況中，旅行和需要集中精神這兩種情況特別突出****

So:

> ****especially when I am travelling or trying to focus****

= ****「尤其是在我旅行或想集中精神的時候」****

And one subtle point is important:

The sentence does ****not**** mean the speaker uses the headphones ****only**** in those situations.

It means:

> ****平時也會使用，但在旅行或需要集中精神時尤其會使用。****